WooCommerce → Practical Stock Planner: File 3 – Open_SO (open customer orders)

Practical Stock Planner – Time-phased inventory planning. One short guide for one file. No IT skills needed – just a WordPress login with the Administrator or Shop Manager role, and Excel.

Checked: against WooCommerce's official docs (woocommerce.com/document, read 2 Oct 2026) and in a live test on a WooCommerce 11.1.2 test site (2 Oct 2026). **Tags: [T]** = tested on screen or in the exported file. **[V]** = checked against WooCommerce's official docs (link given), not tested. **[U]** = unverified – check on screen. Excel tips are general Excel and are not tagged. If a WooCommerce label differs slightly, pick the closest match.

What this file is: customer orders you haven't shipped yet. Columns: `Sales Order ID`, `SKU`, `Open SO Qty`, `Ship Date`.

Before you start

1. **Download the Open_SO template** from the Practical Stock Planner sidebar (📥 *Templates*). Practical Stock Planner accepts **CSV files only** – one CSV file per input file; this one starts from `template_Open_SO.csv`. **Keep the template's header row exactly as it is.** After filling it in Excel, save it with **File › Save As › CSV UTF-8 (Comma delimited)**.
2. **Log in as an Administrator or Shop Manager.** Orders can be viewed by "Admin and Shop Manager" roles [V] (Managing orders).
3. **Match your SOH choice.** WooCommerce has already reduced stock for Processing and On hold orders. If you used *Stock as it is* for SOH (option (b) in the WooCommerce SOH guide), **leave those orders out of this file** – they are already deducted. Only build this file if you added them back to SOH (option (a)).
4. **Set Analytics › Settings › Date type to Date created** and click **Save settings** [T]. The default is **Date paid**; with it, **On hold orders (not paid yet) did not appear** in the Orders report on the test site [T].
5. **Refresh Analytics first.** Analytics updates every 12 hours by default [T]. Click **Update now** in the *Data status* box at the top of the report before you download [T] (Analytics [V]).
6. **Duplicate rows are fine.** Rows for the same SKU and date are simply added up (the app sums by SKU per week, with weeks starting Monday).

   Do you need order-by-order detail? Each week, Practical Stock Planner plans for whichever is higher: your forecast or your open orders. If a SKU's open orders are below its forecast, they don't change the plan, so a single total line per SKU is enough – add the quantities up per SKU in Excel (PivotTable) and leave *Ship Date* blank. Order-by-order detail is only worth the effort when open orders are more than the forecast, for example a large one-off order.

Which orders are open? Processing ("awaiting fulfillment" – your cue to ship) and On hold ("awaiting payment confirmation", e.g. bank transfer) [V] (Order statuses). Completed = fulfilled [V]. **WooCommerce core has no order CSV export** – the Orders screen has no export button or bulk action (only *Move to Trash* and *Change status to…*) [T].

Option A – Analytics › Orders (free)

#	Step	Status
1	Check **Analytics › Settings › Date type** = **Date created** (see *Before you start*).	[T]
2	**Analytics › Orders**. Set **Date range** (Custom) to cover your oldest open order, e.g. the last 3 months.	[T] · [V] Orders report
3	**Show** › **Advanced filters** › **Order status** › **Is** › tick **Processing** and **On hold**.	[T] (filter values seen: Pending payment, Processing, On hold, Completed, Cancelled, Refunded, Failed, Draft; *Is* / *Is Not*; *All* / *Any*)
4	Click **Update now**, then **Download**.	[T]

⚠ If the data runs to **more than one page** (25 rows by default), the CSV is **not downloaded – it's emailed** to the logged-in admin [V]; on the test site a 32-row report showed "Your Revenue Report will be emailed to you." [T]. Set the rows-per-page menu at the bottom of the table to 100 first – the choices are 25/50/75/100 [T]; whether this avoids the email is [U].

Exact header row [T]: `Date,"Order #",Status,Customer,"Customer type",Product(s),"Items sold",Coupon(s),"Net sales",Attribution` Example row [T]: `"2026-09-27 10:00:00",57,processing,"Test Customer2",new,"4× Hoodie - Green, No, 1× T-Shirt",5,,198,Unknown`

WooCommerce	→ Practical Stock Planner column	Notes
Order #	**Sales Order ID**	[T]
Product(s)	**SKU** (via name lookup)	⚠ One cell per order, `quantity× product name`, with **names not SKUs** [T]. Split into one row per product (Excel below), then look up the SKU by name from the **Analytics › Stock** download (column *Product / Variation* – same names, e.g. `Hoodie - Green, No` [T]).
Product(s) quantity	**Open SO Qty**	The number before `×` [T]. Core doesn't track shipped quantities [U] – adjust part-shipped orders by hand.
Date	**Ship Date**	The order date [T] – there's no promised/ship date in core [T]. Past dates = past-due demand (deducted straight away), which is right for orders waiting to ship. Or add your usual dispatch days.
Status	– (check)	`processing` / `on-hold` [T].

Excel – split the Product(s) cell. ⚠ Variation names contain commas (`Hoodie - Green, No`), so you can't simply split at ", " [T]. In Excel 365: `=REGEXREPLACE(F2,", (?=\d+×)","|")` puts a `|` only before each new `n×` item; then *Data › Text to Columns* (delimiter `|`), unpivot (Power Query *Unpivot Columns*), and split each item at the first `×` into quantity and name. Then `=XLOOKUP(name, StockReport[Product / Variation], StockReport[SKU])`.

Option B – Customer / Order / Coupon Export extension (paid, cleanest)

The official marketplace extension **Customer / Order / Coupon Export for WooCommerce** by SkyVerge: **1-year plan $79**, 2-year plan $126.40 [V] (marketplace page; currency shown as `$` – US dollars [U]); 30-day money-back guarantee [V]. It exports orders to CSV/XML "manually or on an automated schedule", with a **Default – One row per item CSV format** among its predefined formats [V] (docs).

#	Step	Status
1	**WooCommerce › Export** › *Manual Export* tab. **Output type** CSV, **Export type** orders, **Format** *Default – One row per item*.	[V]
2	In **Export Options**, target the orders – the marketplace page mentions filtering by "order status" [V]; pick Processing and On hold (labels [U]). Don't tick **Mark as exported** (it excludes them from future exports [V]).	[V] / [U]
3	Click **Export**; download from the admin notice or **WooCommerce › Exports › Export List** (kept 14 days) [V].	[V]

One row per order line gives order number, SKU and quantity per row – exact column names [U] (not tested – paid). Not needed if you have few open orders – Option A works for free.

> **Keep leading zeros in SKUs.** Format the SKU column as *Text* before you type or paste SKUs, then save with *File › Save As › CSV UTF-8 (Comma delimited)*. If you open a CSV directly in Excel (e.g. by double-clicking it), Excel can strip leading zeros (`00123` becomes `123`) – import it via *Data › From Text/CSV* instead and set the SKU column to *Text*. In Google Sheets: select the SKU column and choose *Format › Number › Plain text* before you type or paste, then save with *File › Download › Comma-separated values (.csv)*.

Checklist

- [ ] Template header row unchanged, saved as a CSV file (*File › Save As › CSV UTF-8 (Comma delimited)*).
- [ ] Analytics *Date type* = Date created; **Update now** clicked before downloading.
- [ ] Only Processing and On hold orders; one row per product, with the SKU looked up.
- [ ] Matches your SOH choice: orders listed here **only** if you added them back to SOH.
- [ ] SKUs exactly match your SKU_Details file.
- [ ] At least one data row. No open orders at all? Contact support@practicalsupplychainplanning.com about an "empty" Open_SO file.

If an upload fails: the message *"Please upload a CSV file... Save As CSV UTF-8"* means you uploaded an Excel workbook (`.xlsx`). Open it in Excel, choose *File › Save As › CSV UTF-8 (Comma delimited)*, and upload the `.csv` file instead.

Using Google Sheets instead of Excel? Save each file with *File › Download › Comma-separated values (.csv)*. To keep leading zeros, select the SKU column and choose *Format › Number › Plain text* before you type or paste SKUs.

Set the date format before you upload. On the Load Data page, set **Date format in your files** to match your dates: **Day/Month/Year** (the default, e.g. 05/10/2026 = 5 October) or **Month/Day/Year** (US-style, e.g. 10/05/2026 = 5 October). Only Week Starting Date (Forecast), Ship Date (Open Sales Orders) and Due Date (Open Supply) are read as dates. Dates like 2026-10-05, 2026/10/05 and 13-Apr-2026 are always accepted, whichever setting you choose. If you change the setting, upload the file again. A date that can't fit the setting (e.g. US-style 10/13/2026 under Day/Month/Year) stops the upload, and the message names the file, column, row and value.

Questions? Contact support@practicalsupplychainplanning.com.